

RAGING BULL 🐂

Taurus, the celestial bull, thrusts his star-tipped horns into the night air. The bull is said to represent a disguise adopted by Zeus in a Greek myth. The bright reddish "star" seen here on the bull's back, below the Pleiades, is actually the planet Mars.

MYTHS AND STORIES**THE LOST PLEIAD**

The popular name for the Pleiades is the Seven Sisters, although only six stars are easily visible to the naked eye. Two myths have arisen to explain the "missing" Pleiad. One myth says that the star that shines least brightly is Merope, the only one of the seven sisters to marry a mortal. Another story says that it is Electra, who could not bear to stay and watch the fall of Troy, the city founded by her brother.

The names of the stars in the cluster do not follow either of these legends, however, as the faintest named member is actually Asterope.

WANDERING STAR

This 19th-century painting, *The Lost Pleiad*, depicts the separation of one of the Pleiades from her sisters.

